ready to carry news and opinions on what Indians wanted. Filipe also offered to recruit some journalists in Suva on behalf of the band of three.

Shekhawat said: 'It was a terrific opportunity for the band. Both Eknoa and Filipe were new to the clandestine world and although there was a little apprehension about their loyalty, the band did not know any other way to make life miserable for Rabuka. During this entire event, officers from the MEA and other units of the R&AW in Australia and New Zealand were kept out of the loop. This arrangement protected the secrecy of operation. Despite the clampdown by the military regime in Fiji, protests and pro-democracy demonstrations were intensified. This was clearly the result of the band's great skill and resilience. But much more needed to be accomplished.'

The Betrayal

The most miraculous thing to ever happen to a spy would be the survival of an operation after a betrayal.

To access information, a spy has to betray someone. But being betrayed by a recruit always leaves a scar. It also endangers the operation. In the world of espionage, trust is somewhat like entering a village of cannibals. There is a high chance of being eaten with knives and forks made of deception. In early August 1989, the members of the band found themselves surrounded by cannibals.

While the R&AW spies were reviewing clandestine reports to make reasoned intelligence analyses on Fiji for the Indian government, Benjamin Taylor sought an urgent meeting. Eknoa and Filipe had betrayed the Indian agents, Taylor revealed. He did not know the background but confirmed that Australian